

# 8 Core Focus Areas of a Scrum Master

To serve as a true Agile leader, a Scrum Master must expand their presence beyond standard meeting coordination. Balancing these core dimensions allows the team to achieve self-management, break down internal silos, and consistently build valuable increments.

## 1. Mentoring

Share personal experiences, career stories, and real-world execution lessons learned from historical projects to provide direct developmental guidance to the team.

## 2. Teaching

Explicitly instruct the team on core Agile practices, framework mechanics, underlying core values, and iterative delivery principles.

## 3. Endorsing Scrum

Actively champion and institutionalize the core Scrum values to build team resilience. These values encompass:

- Focus & Openness
- Respect & Courage
- Commitment (FORCCe)

## 4. Taking Action

Step in directly and resolve issues during critical or severe operational situations, particularly when persistent behavioral or collaboration issues threaten team safety.

## 5. Facilitating

Help the team collaborate efficiently to arrive at objective, collective decisions. Ensure that the team retains structural accountability for those shared outcomes.

## 6. Coaching

Guide team members to uncover answers and achieve delivery goals independently. Drive continuous improvement by asking powerful, open-ended questions.

## 7. Knowing When Not to Provide Solutions

Exert continuous situational awareness to step back and deliberately withhold instant answers when the team possesses the capacity to self-organize and self-manage.

## 8. Getting Teams' Focus

Continuously align everyone with the grand Product Vision. Proactively pull team attention back to the overarching purpose of the group when distractions happen.

*Keep the Backlog Healthy. Deliver Maximum Value. Continuous Improvement.*